

How To Project Management



Especially at the beginning of a project, it is important to think about your own resources (such as time) and goals and to find a good way to use these resources and not lose sight of your own goals. To a certain extent, this is also a question of good project management - and that in turn is a matter of "type". A project can be of any size and can be the project of a larger group or an individual undertaking.

To find out what type of person you are when it comes to projects, the **stick figure method** can help:



To do this, draw a stick figure on a piece of paper and write...

1. ...what your cognitive talents are;
Do you like organizing, coordinating, planning, designing, learning, ...?
2. ...what you would like to stand **up** for;
What should be said? What is particularly important to mention?
3. ...to the **heart**, where your passions lie; what are you committed to? What is close to your heart?
4. ...on your **hands**, what manual skills you bring with you
5. ...what is important to you as a basis: What do you need to be able to work well? What should be taken into consideration? What should be done so that you can make good progress?

Leuphana University also **offers** a test that you can take at  to find out what type of writer you are.

A good plan can help you to get off track less quickly or at least find your way back quickly. There are great methods for taking **creative shortcuts and saving** yourself a lot of time that you would otherwise "use" for brooding and despairing or, even worse, for procrastinating, especially when it comes to homework. You can find a particularly useful table on different writing methods [here](#).

Time management also plays an important role. Especially in the first projects that you plan, it is often less a question of getting the job done in the first week of the semester. 

to draw up the perfect plan, which you can then adhere to meticulously. But by creating a schedule, you can go through the project in your head from front to back (or, in the case of backcasting, from back to front) and perhaps discover the first stumbling blocks. The schedule also serves as a guide to how well you are "on time" and helps you to assess whether you need to change or counteract at any point. If you like, there are a number of helpful tools available to support project planning and implementation. Digital tools such as Google Docs and Academic Cloud, Zenkit or Trello are ideal for groups. If you are working on something on your own, a handwritten or digital calendar can get you pretty far. Setting an alarm helps you not to forget anything and remind you of important deadlines in the calendar. Of course, it's a good idea to get to work for a few hours every day rather than just when it suits you - all too often it doesn't suit you... A certain rhythm and routine help to keep you motivated and on track.

This [video](#) summarizes the five best-known project management methods .

Quite a lot of input, huh?

You should invest some time, especially at the beginning of your studies, to find your own way. You quickly realize which methods are useful and which are not. Over time, your own planning becomes automated, so that it is no longer so noticeable that you are using certain methods and routines. Take the time to find out what helps you, which tools are particularly useful for supporting group work and to learn from others.

- And also plan some time for well-deserved breaks!